top to bottom, and people claimed that the sound of nagarets and tambours could be heard from it during the hot seasons.

Babur came across more villages which depended on Kābul itself. To the southwest of the town, there were great snow-covered mountains[8] where snow fell upon snow, and it was rare for a year to pass without fresh snow accumulating on the previous year's layer. This snow was brought, perhaps 12 miles distant, from these mountains to cool drinking water when the ice-houses in Kābul were empty. Similar to the Bāmiān mountains, these were formidable fortresses. They were the source of the Harmand (Halmand), Sind, Dūghāba of Qūndūz, and Balkh-āb rivers so that in a single day, a person could drink water from each of these four rivers.

Most of the villages that depended on Kābul were situated on the slopes of one of these ranges, known as Pamghān. Masses of grapes ripened in their vineyards, and they grew every sort of fruit in abundance. None of them equalled Istālīf or Astarghach; these must have been the two places that Aūlūgh Beg Mīrzā used to call his Khurāsān and Samarkand. Pamghān was another of the best, not matching those two in terms of fruit and grapes but surpassing them in terms of climate. The Pamghān mountains formed a snowy range.

There were few villages that could compare with Istālīf, with vineyards and fine orchards on both sides of its large torrent, boasting waters that needed no ice, were cold, and mostly pure. Aūlūgh Beg Mīrzā had forcibly taken possession of its Great Garden, but Babur took it over, after paying its price to the owners. There was a delightful resting place just outside it, under tall plane trees that were green, shady, and beautiful.

A one-mile stream, flanked by trees on both banks, flowed continuously through the middle of the garden. Originally, its course was zigzag and irregular, but Babur had it straightened and organized, making the place even more beautiful. Between the village and the valley bottom, 4 to 6 miles down the slope, was a spring known as Khwāja Sih-yārān (Three-friends), where three different varieties of trees grew. A group of plane trees provided pleasant shade above it, holm-oak (Quercus bīlūt) grew abundantly on the slope at its sides (except for these two Oaklands, no holm-oak grew in the mountains of western Kābul), and the Judas-tree (arghwān) was extensively cultivated in front of it, toward the level ground —cultivated there and nowhere else. People said that the three different types of trees were a gift from three saints, which explained its name. Babur ordered that the spring be enclosed in mortared stonework,